📚 SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 24

Public Groups in Salesforce

Complete Guide — Group-Based Record Sharing & Security Administration

- 👥 What is a Public Group?
- 🛡️ Simplifying Record Sharing Rules
- 👨 👩 👧 👴 Membership Types & Nesting
- 🏢 Real-World Cross-Department Scenario
- ⚖️ Public Groups vs. Roles
- ⚖️ Public Groups vs. Queues

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL	FOCUS AREA
24 of Series	~18 Minutes	Intermediate	Security & Data Access

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SECTION 1

Introduction & Course Context

⏱ 0:00 – 0:45

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** In the previous episode, we learned about *Field History Tracking* and *Feed Tracking*.

Today, we shift our focus to a fundamental security and record-sharing mechanism: **Public Groups**. In real-world enterprise environments, companies frequently need to grant groups of employees access to shared records across different departments, locations, and roles. Managing this by adding users one by one would quickly turn into an administrative nightmare.

Public Groups solve this by bundling users together, allowing administrators to share records with dozens or hundreds of people in a single step!

SECTION 2

What are Public Groups & Why Do We Need Them?

⏱ 0:45 – 4:30

🏢 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY: THE CROSS-FUNCTIONAL DEAL TEAM

Suppose your business needs to share VIP Account records with all **Sales Managers** and three specific **Customer Support Managers**. Rather than manually sharing every record with each person individually, you create a single container called *"VIP Account Team"*. When you share a record with this group, **every member instantly gains access**!

📌 DEFINITION

A Public Group is an administrator-defined collection of individual users, roles, roles and subordinates, territories, or other public groups created to simplify record sharing, security management, and mass assignments.

⚖️ Without Public Groups vs. With Public Groups

Aspect	❌ Without Public Groups	✅ With Public Groups
Record Sharing	Admin must share records with 15–50 users one-by-one	Share once with the Public Group; everyone gets access
Sharing Rules Complexity	Requires dozens of separate sharing rules	A single clean Sharing Rule targeted at the group
Employee Onboarding	Must manually find and share every historical record	Just add the new hire to the Public Group—instant access!
Maintenance Effort	Extremely high; prone to human errors and security leaks	Minimal effort; centralized access control

SECTION 3

Who Can Be a Member of a Public Group?

⏱ 4:30 – 6:30

One of the greatest powers of Public Groups is their extreme flexibility. A Public Group can contain combinations of:

Individual Users
Specific single users added directly.

Roles
All users currently holding a specific role.

Roles & Subordinates
A role plus all people below them in the hierarchy.

Other Public Groups
Nested groups (group inside another group).

Territories
Users assigned to a sales territory.

Territories & Subordinates
Territory hierarchy members combined.

💡 **NESTED PUBLIC GROUPS**

You can add Public Group "Sales Team" and Public Group "Support Team" into a master Public Group called "All Commercial Staff". This hierarchical nesting saves massive administrative time!

SECTION 4 — CASE STUDY

Real Business Example: Priority Customer Team

⏱ 6:30 – 8:00

THE BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Cross-Department Access

A company has:

- 10 Sales Executives
- 2 Sales Managers
- 3 Customer Support Managers

All 15 users across 2 separate departments need Read/Write access to High-Priority Customer Accounts.

THE SALESFORCE SOLUTION

Public Group + Sharing Rule

Step 1: Admin creates a Public Group: `Priority Customer Team`.
Step 2: Adds the 15 users (via Roles and Users).
Step 3: Creates **1 Criteria-Based Sharing Rule** sharing Accounts where `Rating = 'Hot'` with the Public Group.
Result: When a new executive joins, add them to the group. Zero sharing rule changes needed!

SECTION 5 — STEP-BY-STEP HANDS-ON

Creating a Public Group in Salesforce

⏱ 8:00 – 10:30

1. Click the ⚙ **Setup** gear icon in top right.
2. In the **Quick Find** box, type `Public Groups` and select it.
3. Click **New**.
4. Enter the **Label**: e.g., `Priority Customer Team`.
5. The **Group Name** (API name) auto-populates as `Priority_Customer_Team`.
6. In the **Search** dropdown under *Members*, select the member category:
   - elect `Roles` and choose *Sales Manager* .
   - elect `Users` and add individual support leads.
9. Click **Add** to move them to the *Selected Members* column.
10. Click **Save**. Your Public Group is ready for use! 🎉

SECTION 6

Where Are Public Groups Used in Salesforce?

⏱ 10:30 – 13:00

- **Sharing Rules:** The #1 primary use case. Grants record access based on record ownership or criteria to an entire group of users.
- **Manual Sharing:** When a user manually shares an individual record using the *Sharing* button, they can select a Public Group rather than picking people one-by-one.
- **Salesforce Flows:** Flows can query Public Group memberships to dynamically route tasks, send custom email alerts, or assign records.
- **List Views & Report Folders:** Restrict or share custom List Views, Report Folders, and Dashboard Folders with specific Public Groups.
- **Apex Managed Sharing:** Developers programmatically grant record visibility in Apex code referencing the Public Group ID.
- **Experience Cloud:** Share CRM records or workspaces with partner and customer community user groups.

SECTIONS 7 & 8 — CRUCIAL DISTINCTIONS

Public Groups vs. Roles vs. Queues

⏱ 13:00 – 16:00

1. Public Groups vs. Roles

Criterion	👥 Public Groups	👔 Roles
Primary Purpose	Flexible sharing of records across boundaries	Define reporting structure & hierarchy-based access
Structure	Flat, flexible collection (no hierarchy)	Strict vertical tree/hierarchy (Manager ➔ Subordinate)
Cross-Department	Can group anyone from any department	Tied to a specific position in the organization chart
Record Access Mode	Explicit sharing via rules & folders	Implicit sharing (managers see subordinate records)

2. Public Groups vs. Queues

Criterion	👥 Public Groups	📥 Queues
Can Own Records?	❌ **NO.** Public Groups cannot be record owners.	✅ **YES.** Queues hold record ownership.
Primary Purpose	**SHARE** records and grant visibility	**OWN & DISTRIBUTE** workload (Cases, Leads)
Objects Supported	Virtually all objects for sharing rules	Leads, Cases, Orders, and select Custom Objects
Lifecycle of Record	Record remains with individual owner	Record stays in Queue until an agent "Accepts" it

🧠 MEMORY RULE FOR THE ADMIN EXAM

Public Groups SHARE records. (They provide visibility, never ownership)
Queues OWN records. (They hold unassigned work until claimed)

SECTION 9

Admin Best Practices

⏱ 16:00 – 17:00

- **Use Descriptive Names:** Choose self-explanatory group labels like *"EMEA Enterprise Deal Reviewers"* rather than generic names like *"Group 1"*.
- **Leverage Roles in Groups:** Whenever possible, add *Roles* or *Roles & Subordinates* into the Public Group instead of adding 20 single users. This auto-maintains membership when personnel change.
- **Avoid Over-Creating Groups:** Review existing groups before creating a new one to prevent redundant clutter.
- **Periodic Membership Audits:** Regularly audit group members to revoke access from employees who have moved departments.
- **Combine with Sharing Rules:** Always prefer targeting Sharing Rules at Public Groups rather than single users or complex role branches.

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 24

01
A **Public Group** is a customizable bundle of users, roles, and subordinates designed to streamline record sharing.

02
Eliminates tedious individual user sharing and radically simplifies **Sharing Rules** maintenance.

03
Supports multi-type members: *Users*, *Roles*, *Roles & Subordinates*, *Territories*, and *Nested Groups*.

04
Used across **Sharing Rules**, **Manual Sharing**, **Folder Access**, **Flows**, and **Apex**.

05
Roles govern vertical hierarchy access; **Public Groups** enable horizontal cross-department collaboration.

06
Crucial Exam Distinction: **Public Groups SHARE records**; **Queues OWN and DISTRIBUTE records**.

COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 25

Next Core Salesforce Admin Feature

Stay tuned as we continue building practical, job-ready Salesforce administration and automation skills!

These notes are an official companion to the YouTube video. Practice hands-on in your Salesforce Developer Org!